SSC CHSL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

19 October 2020 · Shift 1

46 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 54 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20210126081103/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerkeyCHSL2019T1_22012021.pdf

English Language (Basic Knowledge) 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'. Over the past 20 years, there "has been" a constant decline in the variety of vegetables that we eat because the native varieties are no longer available.

(A) No improvement
(B) had been
(C) was been
(D) is being

Q.2

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Call a spade a spade

(A) Plan to attack someone with rude words
(B) Say the truth about something, even if it is not pleasant
(C) Lash out unkindly at someone for no reason
(D) Say things that are untrue and painful

Q.3

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. BENEVOLENT

(A) Generous
(B) Liberal
(C) Friendly
(D) Stingy

Q.4

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. You've probably noticed, with great disappointment, that the battery doesn't seem to last as long as it did when it was brand new. B. Partial charging is just fine for lithium-ion batteries and can actually have some positive benefits for cell longevity. C. Smartphone users are forever in search of longer battery life, but unfortunately, battery capacity inevitably declines with age. D. However, one thing you can do to prolong the life of your battery and handset is partial charging.

(A) CDAB
(B) CADB
(C) BADC
(D) ACDB

Q.5

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. At the age of 94, Harbhajan makes barfi only on order and people come to collect the freshly made barfi at her (1)_____. The most remarkable thing is, she manages everything (2)_____ her own, from roasting the gram flour to cutting the (3)_____ shaped barfis. She believes that it is better to wear out than to rust out. Due to her hard work, she received the best (4)_____ when she was named 'entrepreneur of the year'. This 94 year old woman (5)_____ that it's never too late to do a start-up.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 1.

(A) residence
(B) residing
(C) resident
(D) residential

Q.6

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. At the age of 94, Harbhajan makes barfi only on order and people come to collect the freshly made barfi at her (1)_____. The most remarkable thing is, she manages everything (2)_____ her own, from roasting the gram flour to cutting the (3)_____ shaped barfis. She believes that it is better to wear out than to rust out. Due to her hard work, she received the best (4)_____ when she was named 'entrepreneur of the year'. This 94 year old woman (5)_____ that it's never too late to do a start-up.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 2.

(A) to
(B) on
(C) for
(D) with

Q.7

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. At the age of 94, Harbhajan makes barfi only on order and people come to collect the freshly made barfi at her (1)_____. The most remarkable thing is, she manages everything (2)_____ her own, from roasting the gram flour to cutting the (3)_____ shaped barfis. She believes that it is better to wear out than to rust out. Due to her hard work, she received the best (4)_____ when she was named 'entrepreneur of the year'. This 94 year old woman (5)_____ that it's never too late to do a start-up.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 3.

(A) truly
(B) happily
(C) hardly
(D) perfectly

Q.8

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. At the age of 94, Harbhajan makes barfi only on order and people come to collect the freshly made barfi at her (1)_____. The most remarkable thing is, she manages everything (2)_____ her own, from roasting the gram flour to cutting the (3)_____ shaped barfis. She believes that it is better to wear out than to rust out. Due to her hard work, she received the best (4)_____ when she was named 'entrepreneur of the year'. This 94 year old woman (5)_____ that it's never too late to do a start-up.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 4.

(A) appreciation
(B) gratefulness
(C) charm
(D) content

Q.9

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. At the age of 94, Harbhajan makes barfi only on order and people come to collect the freshly made barfi at her (1)_____. The most remarkable thing is, she manages everything (2)_____ her own, from roasting the gram flour to cutting the (3)_____ shaped barfis. She believes that it is better to wear out than to rust out. Due to her hard work, she received the best (4)_____ when she was named 'entrepreneur of the year'. This 94 year old woman (5)_____ that it's never too late to do a start-up.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 5.

(A) has proved
(B) was proved
(C) had been proving
(D) is proved

Q.10

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. Ravina asked her little brother, "Where are you going to play?"

(A) Ravina asked her little brother where he was going to play.
(B) Ravina said to her little brother where he was going to play.
(C) Ravina asked her little brother where he would like to go to play.
(D) Ravina asked her little brother where will he be going to play.

Q.11

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. The country has to struggled with the problems of child labour.

(A) the country has
(B) to struggled with
(C) child labour
(D) the problems of

Q.12

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Disposeable
(B) Harass
(C) Heavenly
(D) Advisable

Q.13

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. The Indian cricket team was done very well this year and is ranked number one now.

(A) and is ranked number one now
(B) this year
(C) The Indian cricket team
(D) was done very well

Q.14

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. One who examines accounts officially

(A) Auditor
(B) Collector
(C) Aviator
(D) Radiator

Q.16

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'. Swami Vivekanand's vast knowledge of Eastern and Western culture appealed to all those "who come in contacts" with him.

(A) that comes to contact
(B) No improvement
(C) which contacted
(D) who came in contact

Q.17

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. REMORSE

(A) Indifference
(B) Reproach
(C) Affection
(D) Regret

Q.18

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. In _____ of the great work he is doing for economically weaker children, he has been given a special award.

(A) resolution
(B) recognition
(C) award
(D) reward

Q.19

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. They are laying new telephone cables in our colony.

(A) New telephone cables are being laid in our colony.
(B) New telephone cables were laid in our colony.
(C) New telephone cables were being laid in our colony.
(D) New telephone cables will be laid in our colony.

Q.20

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. We found it _____ to climb further due to bad weather and decided to give up the expedition.

(A) impossible
(B) boring
(C) exciting
(D) pleasant

Q.21

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options, pick the one that gives their correct order. A. So, what exactly are we eating? B. They found that the vegetables contained very high, toxic levels of banned pesticides, and the pesticide levels were more than 1000 times the permissible levels. C. And is our food giving rise to the many health problems today? D. A survey conducted by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India under the Union Agriculture Ministry tested random samples of vegetables in markets all over India.

(A) ADCB
(B) DBAC
(C) DACB
(D) ACBD

Q.22

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Be behind the times

(A) Be very old
(B) Not be alert
(C) Always dreaming
(D) Be old fashioned

Q.23

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. Repetition of an initial sound in two or more words of a line

(A) Assonance
(B) Rhythm
(C) Alliteration
(D) Rhyme

Q.24

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. CONSPICUOUS

(A) Obscure
(B) Apparent
(C) Distinct
(D) Noticeable

Q.25

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. TIMID

(A) Shy
(B) Willful
(C) Kind
(D) Strong

General Awareness 22 questions

Q.1

The script 'Gurumukhi' for Punjabi language was invented by the Sikh guru _____.

(A) Guru Angad
(B) Guru Har Kishan
(C) Guru Ramdas
(D) Guru Har Rai

Q.3

Which of the following is NOT a North East Indian sister state?

(A) Odisha
(B) Manipur
(C) Meghalaya
(D) Tripura

Q.4

Who among the following is NOT a lawn tennis champion?

(A) Leander Paes
(B) Rohan Bopanna
(C) Sania Mirza
(D) Manika Batra

Q.5

Who has been appointed as the 47th Chief Justice of India?

(A) Ravi Ranjan
(B) Sanjay Karol
(C) Sharad Arvind Bobde
(D) Nilam Sawhney

Q.6

'Santosh Trophy' is an award for the winning team of _____.

(A) hockey
(B) football
(C) volleyball
(D) basketball

Q.7

Abhijit Banerji, an India born researcher, was one of the winners of Nobel Prize 2019 for _____.

(A) Economics
(B) Chemistry
(C) Peace
(D) Literature

Q.8

The Buddhist sites Vaishali and Nalanda are situated in which of the following states?

(A) Chhattisgarh
(B) Bihar
(C) Telangana
(D) Odisha

Q.9

Which of the following cricketers is NOT a part of the Sri Lankan team?

(A) Lasith Malinga
(B) Angelo Perera
(C) Tusara Perara
(D) Kedar Jadhav

Q.11

On which day of the year is the earth farthest from the sun, at a position called aphelion?

(A) 16 August
(B) 23 October
(C) 12 May
(D) 4 July

Q.12

Which is the correct sequence of rulers of the Mughal Empire?

(A) Babur, Humayun, Aurangzeb, Jahangir, Shahjahan, Bahadur Shah, Akbar

(B) Babur, Aurangzeb, Humayun, Jahangir, Shahjahan, Bahadur Shah, Akbar

(C) Babur, Humayun, Akbar, Jahangir, Shahjahan, Aurangzeb, Bahadur Shah

(D) Babur, Jahangir, Humayun, Akbar, Bahadur Shah, Shahjahan, Aurangzeb

Q.13

_____ is defined as the study of behavior of individual decision-making units, such as consumers, resource owners and firms.

(A) Microeconomics

(B) Macroeconomics

(C) Health economics

(D) Econometrics

Q.14

Which of the following devices is NOT used to enter data into a computer?

(A) Mouse

(B) Keyboard

(C) Scanner

(D) Monitor

Q.16

What kind of depositional landforms are formed when streams flowing from higher levels break into foot slope plains of low gradient?

(A) Point bars

(B) Flood plains

(C) Alluvial fans

(D) Natural levees

Q.17

The ‘Bharat Ratna Award 2019’ was NOT conferred upon:

(A) Bhupen Hazarika (posthumous)

(B) Nanaji Deshmukh (posthumous)

(C) Medha Patkar

(D) Pranab Mukherjee

Q.18

Which of the following Public Sector Undertakings does NOT have 'Maharatna' status?

(A) Steel Authority of India Limited

(B) Engineers India Limited

(C) GAIL (India) Limited

(D) Coal India Limited

Q.19

'Behdienkhlam' is a traditional dance festival of which state?

(A) Tamil Nadu

(B) Gujarat

(C) Chhattisgarh

(D) Meghalaya

Q.20

Which Mauryan ruler became a follower of Buddhism?

(A) Samudragupta

(B) Brihadratha

(C) Ashoka

(D) Chandragupta

Q.21

The President of India can hold office for a term of _____ year/s.

(A) 5

(B) 3

(C) 1

(D) 10

Q.22

When blue litmus was added to an unknown liquid in a test tube, it turned red. What was the liquid?

(A) An acid
(B) Saline
(C) An alkali
(D) Water

Q.23

Cirrus and cumulus are types of _____.

(A) mountains
(B) clouds
(C) waves
(D) soil

Q.24

Kartarpur Sahib corridor connects Dera Baba Nanak Shrine in Gurdaspur, India to Kartarpur Gurudwara in Pakistan, which is located near the banks of the river _____.

(A) Ravi
(B) Jhelum
(C) Sutlej
(D) Chenab

Q.25

India is called a secular country because citizens have the fundamental right to:

(A) freedom of speech and expression
(B) move freely throughout India
(C) live with human dignity
(D) freedom to profess religion of one's choice

Answer key

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(A)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(A)**
Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**
Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(A)**
Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(D)**		

Explanations

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 · Answer (A) No improvement

'Over the past 20 years' covers a period lasting up to now, which takes the present perfect: 'there has been a constant decline' is correct as it stands.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Say the truth about something, even if it is not pleasant

To 'call a spade a spade' is to speak plainly and truthfully about something, even when the truth is unpleasant.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Stingy

'Benevolent' means kind and generous; of the options only 'stingy', unwilling to give or spend, is its opposite. 'Generous', 'liberal' and 'friendly' are close to it in meaning.

Q.4 · Answer (B) CADB

C states the problem (battery capacity declines with age), A turns to the reader who has noticed it, D offers a remedy with 'However' (partial charging), and B explains why partial charging is fine: CADB.

Q.5 · Answer (A) residence

After the possessive 'her' a noun is needed for the place where she lives: 'at her residence'. A 'resident' is a person, and 'residential' is an adjective.

Q.6 · Answer (B) on

To do something 'on one's own' is to do it alone, without help: 'she manages everything on her own'.

Q.7 · Answer (D) perfectly

An adverb is needed before the participle 'shaped', and 'perfectly shaped barfis' praises her skill; 'hardly shaped' would mean barely shaped.

Q.8 · Answer (A) appreciation

Being named 'entrepreneur of the year' is recognition of her work: she received 'the best appreciation'. 'Gratefulness' is the feeling of the one who receives a kindness, and 'charm' and 'content' do not fit.

Q.9 · Answer (A) has proved

The woman herself shows something by her example, so the active present perfect is needed: 'has proved that it's never too late'. 'Was proved' and 'is proved' are passive.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Ravina asked her little brother where he was going to play.

A reported question keeps 'asked', takes statement order with no question mark, changes 'you' to 'he' and moves 'are going' back to 'was going': 'where he was going to play'.

Q.11 · Answer (B) to struggled with

'Has to' is followed by the base form of the verb: 'The country has to struggle with the problems of child labour.'

Q.12 · Answer (A) Disposeable

The correct spelling is 'disposable': the final 'e' of 'dispose' is dropped before '-able', as in 'advisable'.

Q.13 · Answer (D) was done very well

The team itself performed, so the verb must be active, not the passive 'was done': 'The Indian cricket team has done (or did) very well this year'.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Auditor

An auditor officially examines the accounts of a business or organisation. An aviator flies aircraft, and a radiator gives out heat.

Q.16 · Answer (D) who came in contact

The main verb 'appealed' is in the past, so the clause needs 'came', and the phrase is 'come in contact with', with a singular 'contact': 'all those who came in contact with him'.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Regret
'Remorse' is deep regret or guilt for a wrong one has done: 'regret'. 'Reproach' is blame or disapproval of someone else.

Q.18 · Answer (B) recognition
'In recognition of' means as an acknowledgement of someone's work or merit, the usual phrase with an award.

Q.19 · Answer (A) New telephone cables are being laid in our colony.
The present continuous 'are laying' becomes 'are being laid' in the passive: 'New telephone cables are being laid in our colony.'

Q.20 · Answer (A) impossible
The bad weather made climbing further 'impossible', which is why they gave up the expedition; 'boring', 'exciting' and 'pleasant' do not explain giving up.

Q.21 · Answer (B) DBAC
D describes the survey, B gives its finding ('They found ...'), and A and C ask the questions that follow from it: DBAC.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Be old fashioned
To 'be behind the times' is to be old-fashioned, not keeping up with modern ideas or ways.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Alliteration
Alliteration is the repetition of the same initial sound in nearby words, as in 'big brown bear'. Assonance repeats vowel sounds, and rhyme matches the endings of words.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Obscure
'Conspicuous' means clearly visible or attracting notice; its opposite is 'obscure', hidden or little known. 'Apparent', 'distinct' and 'noticeable' are close to it in meaning.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Shy
'Timid' means lacking courage or confidence: 'shy'. 'Strong' is nearer its opposite.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Guru Angad
Guru Angad Dev, the second Sikh Guru, is credited with developing and standardising the Gurmukhi script in the 16th century; the Sikh scriptures are written in it.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Odisha
The 'Seven Sisters' of the north-east are Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland and Tripura. Odisha is on the eastern coast.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Manika Batra
Manika Batra is a table tennis player, who won the women's singles gold at the 2018 Commonwealth Games. Leander Paes, Rohan Bopanna and Sania Mirza have all won Grand Slam titles in tennis doubles or mixed doubles.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Sharad Arvind Bobde
Sharad Arvind Bobde was sworn in as the 47th Chief Justice of India on 18 November 2019, succeeding Ranjan Gogoi, and held the office when the exam was held, in October 2020.

Q.6 · Answer (B) football
The Santosh Trophy is India's national football championship for state and institutional teams, first held in 1941.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Economics
Abhijit Banerjee shared the 2019 Nobel Memorial Prize in Economic Sciences with Esther Duflo and Michael Kremer for their experimental approach to alleviating global poverty.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Bihar
Vaishali, where the Second Buddhist Council was held, and Nalanda, seat of the ancient Buddhist university, are both in Bihar.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Kedar Jadhav
Kedar Jadhav is an Indian batsman who has played for India. Lasith Malinga, Angelo Perera and Thisara Perera (printed 'Tusara Perara') have played for Sri Lanka.

Q.11 · Answer (D) 4 July
The Earth reaches aphelion, its farthest point from the Sun, in early July, around 4 July; it is nearest the Sun (perihelion) around 3 January.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Babur, Humayun, Akbar, Jahangir, Shahjahan, Aurangzeb, Bahadur Shah
The Mughal emperors ruled in the order Babur, Humayun, Akbar, Jahangir, Shah Jahan and Aurangzeb, who was followed in 1707 by Bahadur Shah I.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Microeconomics
Microeconomics studies the choices of individual units such as consumers, resource owners and firms; macroeconomics studies the economy as a whole, through aggregates such as national income and inflation.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Monitor
A monitor is an output device: it displays what the computer produces. The mouse, keyboard and scanner are input devices.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Alluvial fans
Where a stream from higher ground reaches a gentle foot slope it slows and spreads out, dropping its coarse load in a fan-shaped deposit, an alluvial fan. Flood plains, natural levees and point bars form along a river's course on the plains.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Medha Patkar
The Bharat Ratna for 2019 went to Pranab Mukherjee and, posthumously, to Nanaji Deshmukh and Bhupen Hazarika. Medha Patkar, the social activist of the Narmada Bachao Andolan, was not among them.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Engineers India Limited
When the exam was held, in October 2020, Engineers India Limited was a Navratna company, while SAIL, GAIL and Coal India were among the Maharatna central public sector enterprises.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Meghalaya
Behdienkhlam is the festival of the Pnar (Jaintia) people of Meghalaya, held at Jowai in July, after the sowing, to drive away disease and evil.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Ashoka
Ashoka turned to Buddhism after the Kalinga war (about 261 BCE) and spread its teaching of dhamma. Samudragupta was a Gupta king, and Chandragupta Maurya is said to have become a Jain.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 5
Under Article 56 the President holds office for a term of five years from the date of entering upon it.

Q.22 · Answer (A) An acid
Acids turn blue litmus red; alkalis turn red litmus blue, and neutral liquids such as water and saline leave both unchanged.

Q.23 · Answer (B) clouds
Cirrus clouds are thin, wispy high clouds; cumulus clouds are puffy, cotton-like heaps with flat bases.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Ravi
Gurdwara Darbar Sahib Kartarpur, in Pakistan's Narowal district, stands across the Ravi from Dera Baba Nanak; the corridor between them opened in November 2019.

Q.25 · Answer (D) freedom to profess religion of one's choice

Articles 25 to 28 give every person freedom of conscience and the right freely to profess, practise and propagate religion, and the State has no religion of its own; this is what makes India secular.

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